—Peter Sbarski

We define a serverless system as one that meets the following criteria:

- No need to manage and maintain virtual machines
- Fully managed service offering scalability and high availability
- Billed per request and by resource consumption

AWS Lambda certainly fits these definitions and is indeed a serverless platform in that AWS handles server configurations and management so the server is essentially invisible to you and takes care of itself. AWS is not the only provider offering a serverless platform. Google (Cloud Functions) and Microsoft (Azure Functions) are other competitors in this area. If you would like to read more about serverless, here is a free chapter from *Serverless Architectures on AWS,* second edition: http://mng.bz/qoEx.

6.1.2 Running your code on AWS Lambda

AWS Lambda is the basic building block of the serverless platform provided by AWS. The first step in the process is to run your code on Lambda instead of on your own server.

As shown in figure 6.1, to execute your code with AWS Lambda, follow these steps:

1. Write the code.
2. Upload your code and its dependencies (such as libraries or modules).